

Web Accessibility Scanner — User Manual

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1. What This Tool Does

The Web Accessibility Scanner tests any public website for compliance with the **Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1/2.2**, levels A, AA, and AAA. It combines the industry-standard **axe-core** engine with a set of custom checks for gaps axe-core doesn't cover (captions, focus order, non-text contrast, and more).

For each scan you get:

- A **0–100 accessibility score** and letter grade (A–F)
- A full list of **violations**, grouped by severity, each pointing to the exact HTML element responsible
- **Developer-ready fix guidance** for each violation (before/after code snippets)
- Optional **legal compliance reports** (ADA, Section 508/VPAT, EN 301 549, and 8 other regional standards) as PDF or HTML

No account or login is required to run a scan — the tool issues a temporary guest session automatically.

2. Running a Scan

1. Open the scanner in your browser.
2. Enter the full URL of the page you want to test (e.g. `https://www.example.com`) in the input field.
3. Choose a **scan depth**:
 - **0 — Single page** (default): tests only the URL you entered. Fastest option.
 - **1 — Follow links**: also tests up to 10 links found on that page, as long as they're on the same domain. Slower, but useful for a broader site audit.
4. (Optional) Check **Auto-Generate Compliance Report** if you want a formal legal-style report generated automatically once the scan finishes. Selecting this reveals:
 - **Standard**: which regulation to report against (see §5)
 - **Format**: PDF or HTML
 - **Product/Vendor details**: name, version, vendor, contact info, notes — these appear on the report's cover page
5. Click **Scan Now**.

A scan typically takes a few seconds to a couple of minutes depending on depth and page complexity. You'll see a loading indicator while it runs.

Note: Scans of private/internal addresses (localhost, 127.x, 10.x, 192.168.x, etc.) are blocked by default for security reasons. If you need to test an internal staging site, ask whoever manages the server to enable that explicitly.

3. Reading Your Results

Score Cards

At the top of the results you'll see four summary numbers:

Card	Meaning
Score	0–100 score with a letter grade (A/B/C/D/F) — see §4 for how it's calculated
Compliance	% Share of all checks that passed
Violations	Total number of accessibility issues found
Passes	Total number of checks the page passed

If enabled, you'll also see an **AudioEye Score** card — an alternative scoring method that weights failures per WCAG success criterion rather than per rule (see §4).

Violation List

Each violation is shown as a card with:

- A **color-coded left border**: red = critical, orange = serious, yellow = moderate, green = minor
- The **rule name** and a plain-language **description** of the problem
- The exact **HTML element(s)** on the page that triggered it
- If you requested a visual report, a **screenshot** of the page with the problem element highlighted and numbered
- An expandable "**How to fix**" section with step-by-step instructions and a before/after code example you can hand directly to a developer

Passes and Incomplete Sections

- **Passes**: checks the page satisfied — useful to confirm what's already working.
 - **Incomplete**: checks that couldn't be fully automated and need a human to verify (e.g. "does this instruction rely on color alone?"). These are not failures — they're flagged for manual review.
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4. Understanding Your Score

Two independent scoring methods run on every scan:

Standard Score (default)

Starts at 100 and subtracts points for each violation based on severity:

Severity Points deducted per violation

Critical	–20
Serious	–10
Moderate	–5
Minor	–2

Grade scale: A ≥ 90 · B ≥ 75 · C ≥ 40 · D ≥ 25 · F < 25

AudioEye Score (supplementary)

Instead of counting violations, this measures what *percentage of tested elements* fail, per WCAG success criterion, then averages across all criteria equally. It's a good sanity check if a page has one rule with many

repeated instances (which can skew the standard score) — the AudioEye score won't over-penalize a single systemic issue.

Both scores use the same A–F letter grades.

5. Generating a Compliance Report

Compliance reports translate your scan results into the format expected for legal/regulatory documentation. Available standards:

Standard	Region / Use case
ADA Title III	US — general legal compliance
Section 508 (VPAT)	US — federal/government procurement
CVAA	US — video/communications accessibility
EN 301 549	European Union
EAA (European Accessibility Act)	European Union
Equality Act 2010	United Kingdom
AODA	Ontario, Canada
ACA (Accessible Canada Act)	Canada — federal
BITV 2.0	Germany
DDA 1992	Australia
GIGW 3.0	India — government websites

Each report includes a conformance table mapping every relevant WCAG success criterion to a status (Supports / Partially Supports / Does Not Support / Not Applicable / Not Evaluated), plus narrative remarks explaining the assessment. You can generate a report either automatically at scan time (see §2) or afterward from the results view.

Reports are available as:

- **HTML** — viewable in-browser, printable
 - **PDF** — downloadable, includes page numbers and a table of contents
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6. Exporting Results

From the results view you can:

- **Download XLSX** — exports the full violation list as an Excel workbook, useful for tracking remediation work in a spreadsheet
 - **Generate Compliance Report** — produces a PDF/HTML report as described in §5
 - **Print** — uses your browser's print dialog for a quick paper/PDF copy
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7. Admin Console

The admin console lets an administrator adjust server-wide scanning behavior. It's hidden from regular users by design.

To open it:

1. Locate the small, mostly-invisible dot in the top-right corner of the page.
2. Click it **5 times within 3 seconds**.
3. Enter the admin password when prompted.

What you can configure:

- **Max Concurrent Scans** — how many scans the server will run at once
- **Scoring Formula** — switch between the penalty-based and compliance-percentage scoring methods
- **Active Engine** — switch between the axe-core engine and the native custom-rules engine
- **Scan Mode** — serial (server processes linked pages one at a time) vs. parallel (your browser requests them concurrently) when using scan depth 1
- **WCAG Coverage Upload** — upload a spreadsheet to update the reference table of which WCAG success criteria are implemented, partial, or missing

Admin sessions last **30 minutes** and end automatically when you close the browser tab.

If you see "admin console password is not configured," the site administrator hasn't set an admin password on the server yet — this is a server configuration step, not something fixable from the browser.

8. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause / fix
"Invalid URL" error	Make sure the URL starts with <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> and is a complete, publicly reachable address
Scan takes a long time or times out	Very large or slow-loading pages can exceed the scan time limit; try scan depth 0 instead of 1, or try again
"Too many requests" (429)	The scanner is rate-limited to prevent abuse; wait about a minute and try again
"Could not reach the API server" / failed to fetch	Usually a temporary network/DNS issue on your end — refresh the page. If it persists across a full browser restart, report it to your administrator
Scan blocked with a private-address error	You're trying to scan an internal/private URL (localhost, 192.168.x, etc.); this is blocked by default for security
Admin console won't unlock	Make sure you're clicking the trigger dot 5 times within a 3-second window; if you don't know the password, contact your administrator

9. Quick Reference

Action	Where
Run a scan	Enter URL → Scan Now
Broader site check	Set scan depth to "1 — Follow links"
See exact broken elements	Expand any violation card
Get a fix for a specific issue	Open "How to fix" inside a violation card
Legal/compliance document	Check "Auto-Generate Compliance Report" before scanning, or generate one from the results view
Export to spreadsheet	"Download XLSX" in the results view

Action**Where**

Change server-wide
settings

5-click the hidden dot (top-right) → admin password